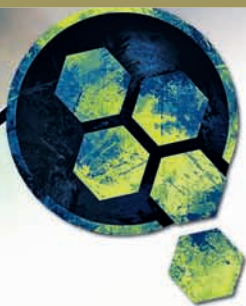




preview



BIONIC C O M M A N D O

Kumar Jhuremalani

Imagine a a cyborg with a bionic arm — an age-old concept by none other than Capcom. The original *Bionic Commando* was released in 1987, and now in 2009, a new and significantly improved avatar of that classic is ready to take on the world. So we have another remake of a game, but how good is it really? We managed to get an early look at the game and played the training level and a part of the first level on the Sony PlayStation 3; here are our findings.

The story continues where it last left off, but this time BioReign has the city in chaos and has taken over completely. The game finds a cityscape in complete ruins with totally devastated sky scrapers. It's as if the city had been hit by a meteor storm or something similarly catastrophic; completely wiping it out. You play the original bionic commando Nathan "RAD" Spencer, who finds himself stripped of his bionics due to a series of events that take place after his involvement in some covert operations. The game reunites him with his bionic arm and he is the now only one who can save the city.

When we initially started this game, we hit the training level where you get used to the game's controls and your character's moves. The arm is primarily used as a grappling hook. This was the way the original played as well, but you couldn't really jump in that classic. However, jumping around is essential to play this new game. Not only is

your arm a weapon, but you get to perform some really cool moves and lift heavy objects such as cars; whipping them around to destroy life and property. Special moves will be highlighted on the right of the screen while using your bionic arm.

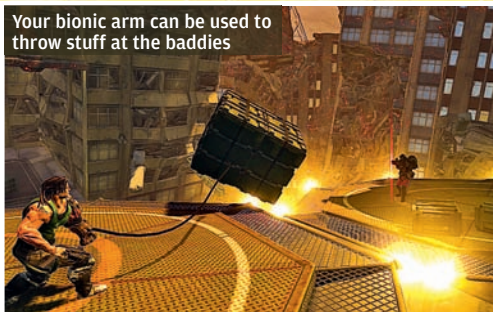
You also hold a weapon in your other hand, which, when you start off, is a pistol with limited ammo. It would have been cooler to see a huge weapon that could be attached to the bionic arm. Anyway, you can also zoom in with your side arm and aim using the other analogue control stick. Battles consist of a series of attack combinations where you can use the bionic arm and the pistols together.

There's a slight problem we feel is in the game — the bionic arm can attach to almost anything. Even if you're on broken roads you can use the arm to attach to the debris. This causes slight confusion when fighting the bad guys. But again, once you get used to the controls, this really won't be much of an issue. Another small thing is that the D-pad is used for quick turns, but you can't do a quick look up, which would have been helpful.

From what we saw, this game was looking really good on the PS3 and it's not even complete yet. We were informed that a better build with many more levels would be ready soon and the game is scheduled to launch in May 2009, for the PS3 and the Xbox 360. PC enthusiasts will have to wait a while longer to get their hands on this game. ■

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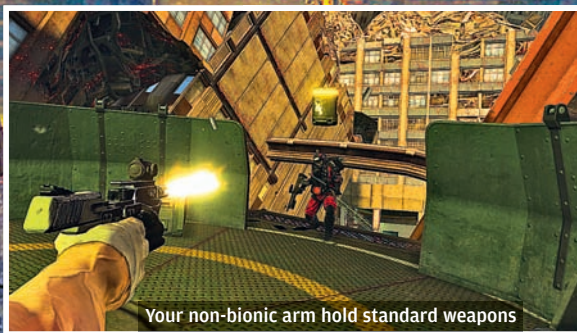
Your bionic arm can be used to throw stuff at the baddies



You also swing around the cityscape using your bionic arm



Your non-bionic arm hold standard weapons



ESC